to listen to that night's AIR news broadcast, to understand what he had just told him.

The same night at 9.15 p.m., Indira Gandhi addressed the nation on the state-owned television and radio channels. She recounted details of the efforts made by her government to reach a peaceful settlement with the Akali leaders. Once again, she appealed to them not to go ahead with their agitation, which was supposed to begin on 3 June, and instead accept the peaceful settlement the government had offered. 'Let us join hands together and heal the wounds ... don't shed blood, shed hatred,' she appealed to all Punjabis.

Later that night the government announced on AIR that the army had been called to support the civilian authorities in Punjab and that Lt Gen. Ranjit Singh Dayal, chief of staff, Western Command, would hold the key post of advisor (security) to the governor of Punjab. The police and paramilitary forces would work under the overall command of the army. Also, Lt Gen. Dayal, assisted by Maj. Gen. K.S. Brar, was put in overall charge of the Golden Temple operation, code-named 'Blue Star'. [6], [7]

Simultaneously, by the evening of 2 June, the army sealed the international border with Pakistan from J&K to Sri Ganganagar in Rajasthan. At least seven divisions of the army were deployed in various villages of Punjab. By evening the media was gagged. Rail, road and air services in Punjab were suspended and a three-day curfew imposed in the whole of Punjab.

On 2 June, Mark Tully met Bhindranwale for the last time. Tully found him not his usual relaxed self, but somewhat tense. Always willing to give interviews to foreign correspondents, Bhindranwale said, 'You will have to hurry up. I have got more important things to do.'

The next day, when the *Times of India* reporter Subhash Kirpekar met Bhindranwale and drew his attention to the deployment of the army, Bhindranwale said the army would also behave the way the CRPF and BSF had been behaving in the past. When his attention was drawn towards the heavier deployment of the better equipped army, Bhindranwale said, 'Sheep always outnumber lions. But one lion can take care of a thousand sheep ... He is not a Sikh who fears death and he who fears death is not a Sikh.' When Kirpekar asked